

BOOK REVIEWS/BOEKBESPREKINGS

Statistische Auswertungsmethoden, by *L. Sachs*.

Second enlarged edition, 677 pages, 59 figures and 190 tables. Springer — Verlag, Berlin, 1969. DM 58.00; US \$ 14.50.

This is a surprisingly comprehensive handbook on statistical methods for non-mathematicians. The almost 700 pages contain an enormous variety of material. The book starts with remarks on the 4 basic arithmetical operations, and has chapters on elementary probability and basic ideas of inference, on applications to medicine and technology, on various statistical tests, on regression and correlation and on analysis of variance. All this (which contains references to game theory, linear programming, sequential analysis etc.) is rounded off with remarks on the history of Statistics, a large bibliography, a list of statistical journals and even of addresses of firms supplying probability paper.

The book is original in its layout and up to date insofar as it takes very recent research work into consideration. The author is fascinated by nonparametric techniques, the result is almost a *handbook on nonparametric methods*. The fields which, in my opinion, account nowadays for about 80-90% of all reasonable applications of Statistics: design and analysis of experiments, and sample surveys are either insufficiently, or not at all, treated. But this is, of course, a matter of personal experience and preference and cannot be held against the author.

I would not recommend the book for self study, with possible exception of a few selected sections. The examples of application are all entirely numerical and artificial. They are of use if one wants to find out quickly, without wading through notation, how something has to be calculated. But the beginner needs good and reasonable and real applications. He needs also a *small* selection of well chosen material. As handbook it is very useful. One must, however, neither expect to find every matter, nor everything on many matters which are only very shortly treated. But even the specialist will find many things of which he has never heard before, and many new and unknown references (many of them continental).

The book contains about 60 mathematical and statistical tables. It is durably bound, the print (offset) is large and clear but not too beautiful.

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